



HIIT 101

HIIT • DAY 2

The Science of Fat Burning in 20 Minutes

Day 2 of 30 | High-Intensity Interval Training

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01 | What Is HIIT?

High-Intensity Interval Training (HIIT) alternates short bursts of maximum effort with brief recovery periods. Instead of jogging for 60 minutes, you push hard for 20–40 seconds, rest, and repeat. The result: more fat burned in less time, with benefits that last hours after you stop.

The key mechanism is EPOC — Excess Post-Exercise Oxygen Consumption. After intense effort, your body burns extra calories for up to 24 hours restoring oxygen levels, repairing muscle, and clearing metabolic byproducts. Steady-state cardio stops burning the moment you stop moving. HIIT keeps working.

Metric	HIIT (20 min)	Steady Cardio (45 min)
Calories during	250–350 kcal	300–400 kcal
Calories after (EPOC)	100–200 kcal extra	~10 kcal
Total fat burned	Higher (long window)	Lower (stops at end)
Muscle preservation	High	Low (can break down muscle)
Time required	20 minutes	45–60 minutes
Equipment needed	None	None

■ INFO — Heart Rate Zones

HIIT works in Zone 4–5 (80–95% max HR). Estimate your max HR: 220 – your age. Example: age 30 → max HR 190 bpm. Target 152–180 bpm during work intervals.

02 | HIIT Structures Explained

There are four main HIIT formats. Today you will use **Work:Rest**. As you progress through the 30 days you will encounter all four formats.

Format	Structure	Best For	Used On
Work:Rest	30 sec on / 30 sec off	Beginners, Day 2	Days 2, 8, 15
Tabata	20 sec on / 10 sec off × 8	Fat loss, max effort	Day 9, 24
EMOM	X reps every minute on the minute	Strength + cardio	Day 15
AMRAP	As many rounds as possible in set time	Endurance, fitness testing	Day 28

■■ WARNING — Common HIIT Mistakes

1. Skipping the warm-up → risk of injury. 2. Not going hard enough during work intervals → no EPOC benefit. 3. Doing HIIT every day → overtraining, no recovery. Max 3–4 sessions/week.

03 | Day 2 HIIT Workout — 20-Minute Fat Burner

Format: Work 30 sec / Rest 30 sec | **Rounds:** 3 | **Equipment:** None | **Total time:** ~20 minutes

WARM-UP (4 minutes — do not skip)		
Exercise	Duration	Notes
March in place	60 sec	Pump arms, raise knees
Arm circles	30 sec	Forward then backward
Hip circles	30 sec	Both directions
Leg swings	30 sec	Hold wall if needed
Light jumping jacks	60 sec	Controlled pace
Inchworm walk-out	30 sec	Hands to floor, walk out, walk back

MAIN CIRCUIT — 3 Rounds (30 sec work / 30 sec rest)			
#	Exercise	Modification	Log reps R1 / R2 / R3
1	High Knees	March in place	___ / ___ / ___
2	Squat Jump	Bodyweight squat (no jump)	___ / ___ / ___
3	Push-Up	Knee push-up	___ / ___ / ___
4	Skaters	Side step (no hop)	___ / ___ / ___
5	Burpee	Step-back burpee	___ / ___ / ___
6	Mountain Climbers	Slow mountain climbers	___ / ___ / ___
	Rest 90 sec between rounds		

■ INFO — How Hard Should "Hard" Feel?

During work intervals: you should NOT be able to hold a full conversation. A word or two is fine. If you can talk freely, go faster. If you cannot breathe at all, slow down slightly.

04 | Cool-Down + Quick Reference

COOL-DOWN (3 minutes)

Exercise	Duration
Walk in place	60 sec
Standing hamstring stretch (each leg)	30 sec
Hip flexor lunge stretch (each side)	30 sec
Chest opener — arms wide, deep breath	30 sec
Child's pose or seated forward fold	30 sec

05 | HIIT Quick Reference Card

Rule	Detail
Frequency	Max 3–4 HIIT sessions per week. Never two days in a row.
Duration	15–25 minutes is enough. More is not better with HIIT.
Intensity	80–95% max heart rate during work intervals.
Nutrition before	Light snack 60–90 min before. Avoid heavy meals.
Nutrition after	Protein within 30–45 min after to support recovery.
When to skip HIIT	Sick, injured, or slept less than 5 hours — do mobility instead.

06 | Day 2 Self-Check Question

Question:

"After completing today's HIIT session, what was your biggest challenge — physical (breathing, legs) or mental (wanting to stop)? What will you do differently in your next session?"

Write your answer here:

Next up — Day 3: Core Anatomy – Why Your Core Is More Than Abs

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